

CONTEXT

Understanding the scenario

Scenario summary. After a new CRM system was introduced, the organisation experienced a major drop in performance. This decline breached the minimum CSAT scores required by contract.

This slide tracks the journey from the initial failure to a new, more stable state.

The Phase	Key Events & Drivers	Systemic Impact
01. The Drop	The CRM launch focused on internal systems but failed to prepare customer-facing staff.	12% CSAT Floor: A sharp drop in customer satisfaction fell below the contractual minimum.
02. The Shock	A ransomware attack struck during peak season, making the rollout issues worse.	Performance decline: Response times increased as staff struggled with mental overload.
03. The Pivot	Leadership responded by increasing capacity by 40% and investing in staff training.	Structural Shift: The focus moved from short-term technical fixes to long-term skill building.
04. The Result	Performance began to improve after a 13-week lag while training took effect.	17% Net Gain: Customer satisfaction not only recovered but exceeded previous levels.

Disclaimer:

This is a fictional scenario using example data. It shows how visual tools can support systems analysis and communication. It is not intended as a real audit, consultation, or recommendation.

METHOD

Understanding the system through visual artefacts

Summary. Instead of relying on a single explanation, this case study uses a small set of visual artefacts. Each one answers a different question about system behaviour. Together, they help show what happened and why without claiming certainty or ownership of the analysis.

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The Artefacts

01. Behaviour Over Time (Indicator View)

Question it answers: What changed — and when?

Shows how the key performance measure (CSAT) changed over time. It highlights dips, thresholds, and patterns of recovery. This gives everyone a shared starting point for discussion before drawing conclusions.

02. Contextual Weave (Pressures, Accumulation)

Question it answers: What was happening around the indicator?

Adds context by showing pressures and build-ups over time. This makes delays and background strain easier to see, without forcing a simple explanation.

03. Decision & Action Timeline (Lead Times)

Question it answers: Why didn't results change immediately?

Separates strategic choices from operational actions and results. It makes it clear where delays happened, so the timing of improvements is not misunderstood.

04. System Evidence Table (Phase Alignment)

Question it answers: Do observed signals align with the proposed system behaviour?

Uses grouped charts and summaries to compare what happened with the expected system behaviour. This helps test whether the explanation fits the evidence, without blurring observation and interpretation.

05. Causal Loop Diagram (Structural Hypothesis)

Question it answers: What structure could plausibly explain this pattern?

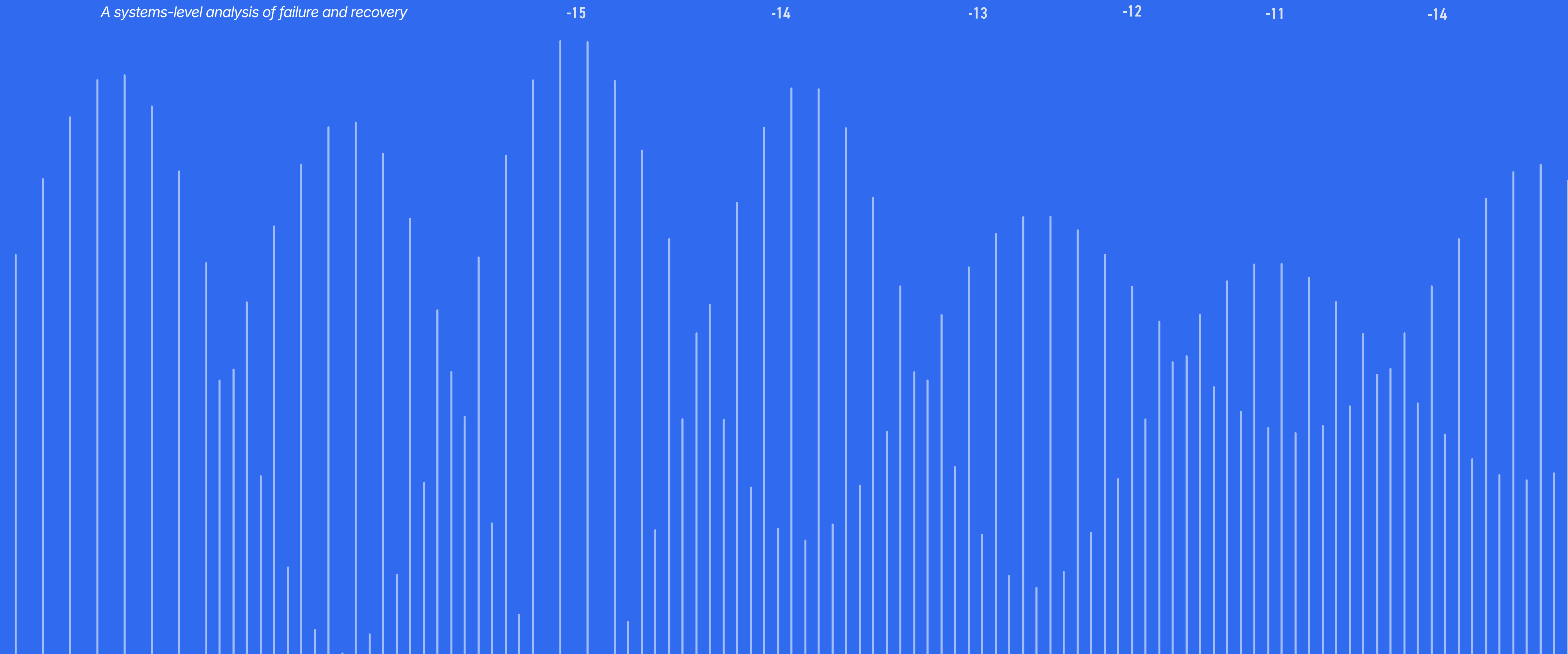
Shows a high-level map of feedback loops that may be driving the behaviour. It is not a final answer, but a tool to support shared understanding.

CASE STUDY

Understanding a systemic crisis

A systems-level analysis of failure and recovery

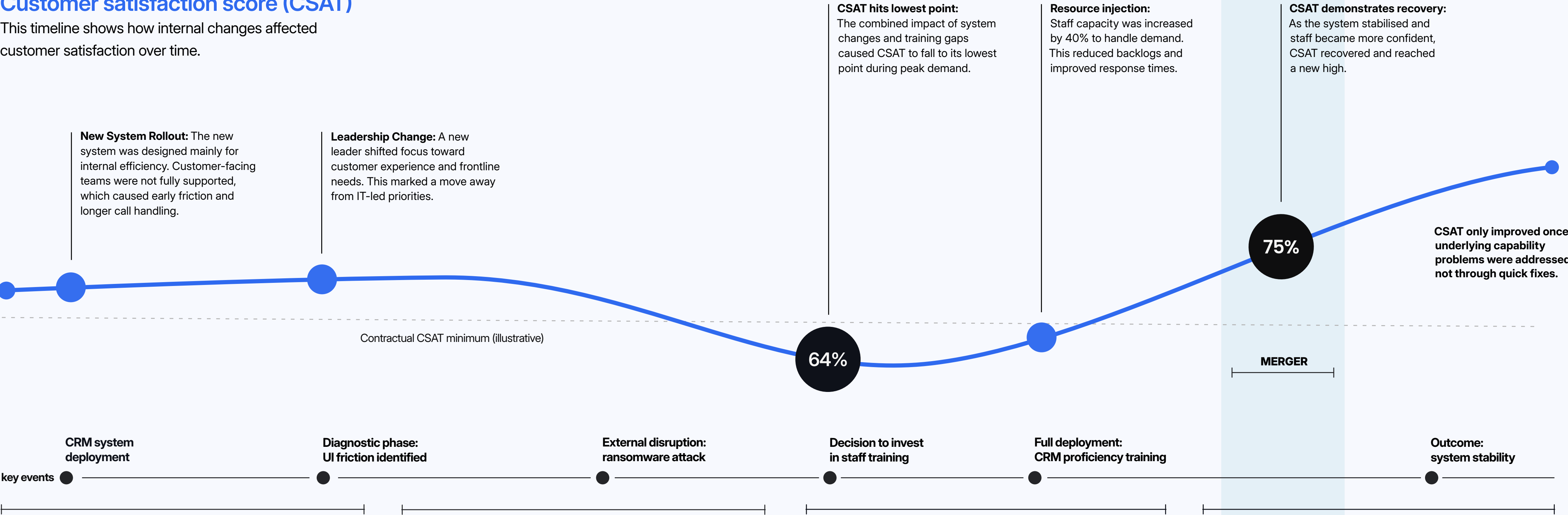
Why CSAT dipped — and why it recovered



Tracking CSAT over time

Customer satisfaction score (CSAT)

This timeline shows how internal changes affected customer satisfaction over time.



01. First quarter

Implementation & friction. Staff struggled to use the new system and fix early technical issues, leading to an initial drop in performance.

02. Second quarter

Stabilisation & diagnosis. The team focused on fixing the core system and understanding where staff were struggling.

03. Third quarter

Improvement phase. Investment in training and revised shift patterns helped reduce queues during busy periods.

04. Fourth quarter

Stable performance. With trained staff and a stable system, performance improved and CSAT reached a new high.

Why CSAT fell and how it recovered

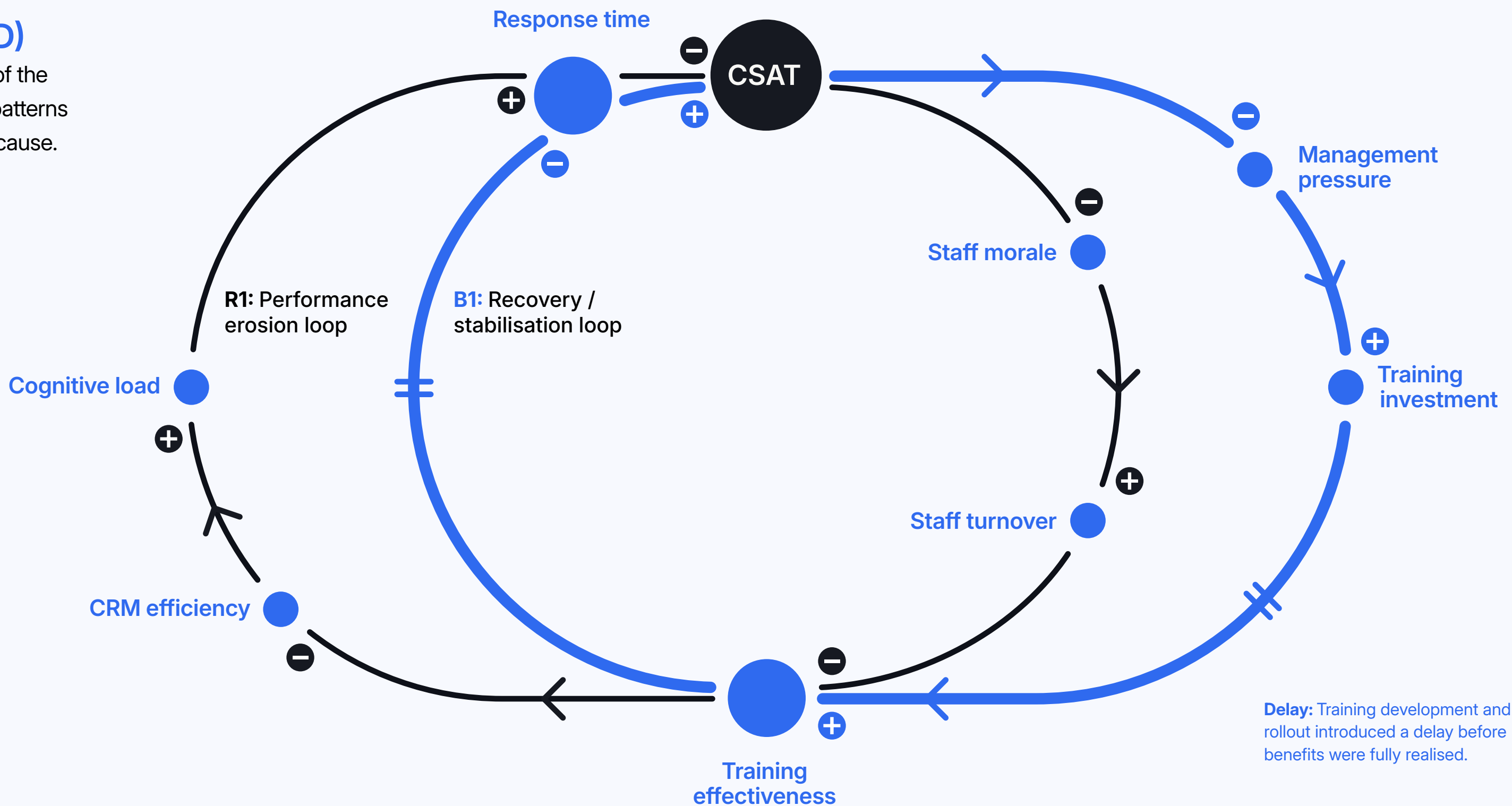
Causal Loop Diagram (CLD)

This diagram shows how different parts of the system interacted over time. It explains patterns in CSAT, rather than pointing to a single cause.

Response time: Response times increased because staff struggled to use the new system and find customer information during calls.

Cognitive load: The new system required more effort to use, increasing mental strain for frontline staff.

CRM efficiency: The system had useful features, but staff did not know how to use them properly at first.



RANSOM WARE ATTACK

An external shock resulted in pressure on CSAT

Training Investment: Leadership decided to invest in staff training to rebuild skills and stabilise service levels.

Training Effectiveness: As training rolled out, staff became more confident and used the system more consistently.

Staff Morale: High stress lowered morale and led to staff leaving, which reduced team capacity and made performance worse.

Staff turnover: Several team members left shortly after the new system was introduced.

01. Early phase

Problems reinforced each other, and performance declined quickly.

02. Middle phase

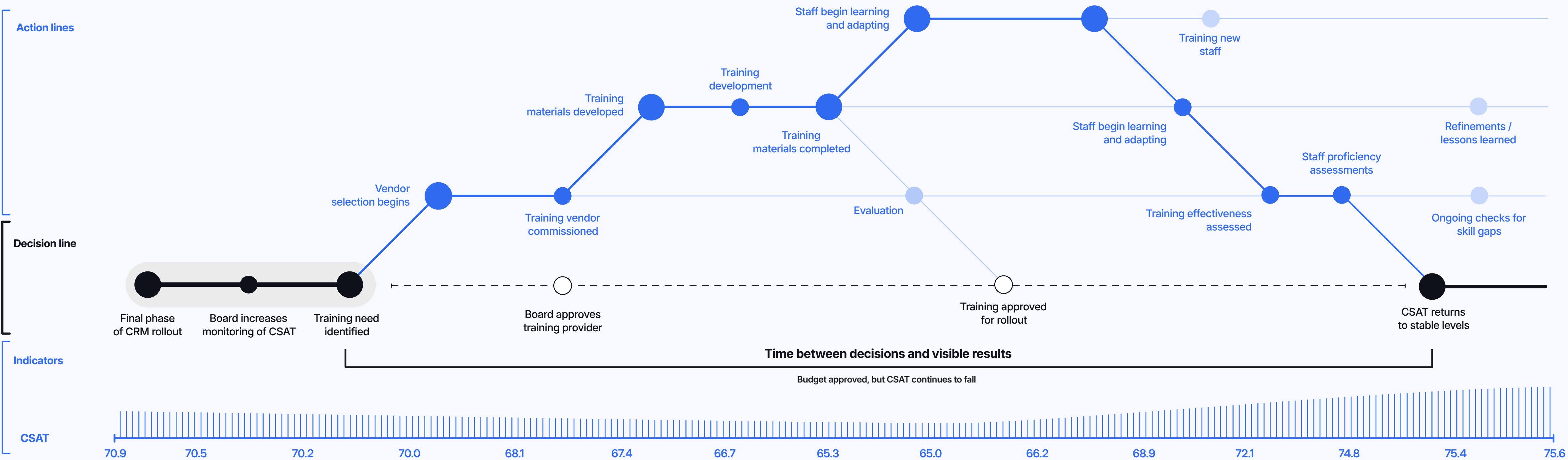
Recovery actions started, but results were delayed while capacity was rebuilt.

03. Later phase

Recovery effects outweighed earlier problems, and the system stabilised.

How CRM training took time to affect performance

Why decisions did not improve results straight away



01. Decision line

This line shows how leadership responded to falling performance. It tracks the move from monitoring the problem to approving funding for training.

02. Action lines

This line shows the work that continued after decisions were made. Even while CSAT kept falling, teams were selecting providers, building training, and giving staff time to learn.

03. Indicators

CSAT continued to fall even after the need for training was identified. Scores only began to improve once staff had time to learn and use the new system. Performance improved after capability improved, not before.

CSAT, pressures and accumulation

Outcomes and context:
reading change over time

This view brings together three simple ways of looking at performance over time.

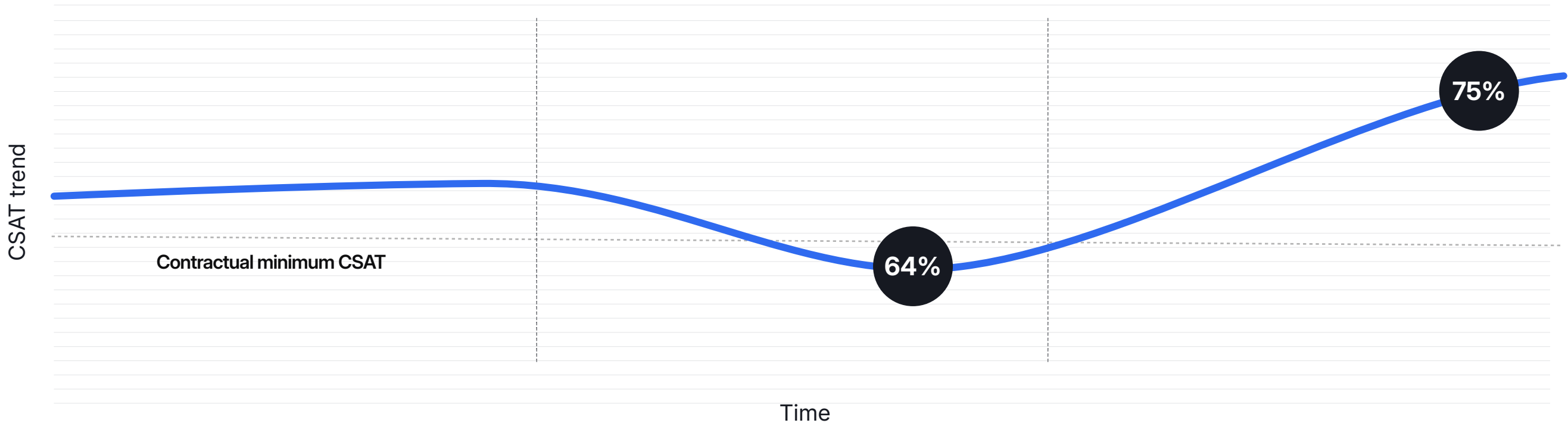
Instead of looking at the CSAT metric on its own, it shows what was happening around it. It makes pressures, delays, and build-ups over time visible, which helps people understand why CSAT dipped and recovered.

The aim is not to prove cause and effect. It is to help people make sense of the pattern by showing the surrounding context.

Indicators shown are illustrative proxies;
trends are emphasised over point precision.

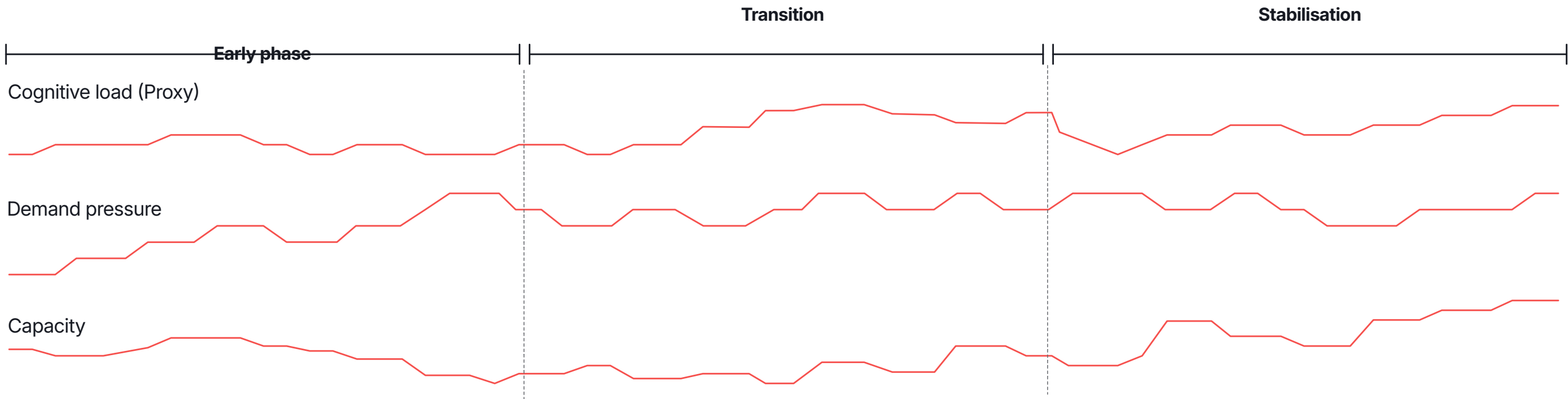
Customer satisfaction (CSAT)

This chart shows how customer satisfaction changed over time. It shows what happened, not why it happened.



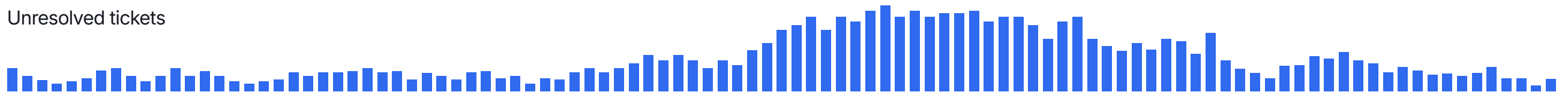
Pressures

These signals show pressures that were present over time. They are included to support interpretation, not to claim direct causes.



Accumulation

This view shows work that builds up and clears over time. It makes delays and persistence visible.



Key system variables

Systemic alignment:
evidence of the recovery cycle

This table summarises observed indicators aligned to the system variables in the causal loop diagram.

Spark-lines highlight changes across phases, making relative timing and trend direction visible while preserving the distinction between observation and explanation.

Indicators shown are illustrative proxies; trends are emphasised over point precision.

Variable	Early phase	Mid phase	Late phase	Notes
CSAT				Stability: CSAT only recovered once training was in place and day-to-day work became more stable.
Avg response time				Response times: Response times worsened during the disruption, then improved after the staff completed the training.
Cognitive load (proxy AHT error rate)				Learning effort: Staff experienced high strain while learning the new system, which eased over time.
Staff turnover	4	2	1	Staff loss: More staff left during the period of highest pressure.
Training effectiveness	Low	Low / Medium	Medium / High	Training delay: There was a clear gap between launching training and seeing real improvement in daily work.
CRM efficiency	Low	Low	Low / Medium	Skills build-up: Teams took time to use the system effectively, even after it was technically available.